

Johanna Escudero Pino

Public health analyst | Wellington, New Zealand
joescudero@hotmail.com | 027 387 8382

PROFILE

Public health analyst with distinction-level postgraduate training in policy analysis, biostatistics, and regulatory impact assessment, combined with ten years of frontline clinical experience in New Zealand's oral health sector. Particular interest in oral health policy, health equity, Te Tiriti-grounded health analysis, and the use of quantitative methods to support population health decisions. Fluent in English and Spanish; based in Wellington.

EDUCATION

Postgraduate Diploma in Public Health | *University of Otago, Wellington* 2023–2024

Awarded with distinction. Papers included Public Health Policy, Applied Biostatistics (Regression Methods), Epidemiology, Hauora Māori, and Health Protection. Developed practical capability in policy analysis, regulatory impact assessment, quantitative analysis, evidence synthesis, health impact assessment, and Te Tiriti-informed health analysis.

Diploma in Cosmetic Dentistry | *Universidad de Buenos Aires, Argentina* 2012

Bachelor of Dentistry (programme interrupted) | *Universidad de Antioquia, Colombia* 2007–2011

Completed four years of clinical dental training, including oral anatomy, clinical practice, restorative dentistry, and prosthetics. Programme interrupted by extended industrial action; subsequently relocated to New Zealand.

POLICY & ANALYTICAL WORK

Parliamentary Submission — Restoring Smokefree Legislation in Aotearoa | *PUBH 714, University of Otago* 2024

- Wrote a mock parliamentary submission to the Health Committee recommending restoration of the three tobacco control measures repealed in 2024 (retail outlet reduction, denicotinisation, smokefree generation).
- Applied regulatory impact assessment principles including cost-benefit analysis, distributional analysis across population groups, and assessment of implementation trade-offs.
- Critically analysed tobacco industry counter-arguments using peer-reviewed evidence; produced an implementation pathway with phased rollout, cross-party engagement strategy, and accountability mechanisms.

Health Impact Assessment — Community Water Fluoridation, Wellington & Taranaki | *Health Protection paper, University of Otago* 2024

- Conducted a full Health Impact Assessment (HIA) following the Ministry of Health Guide to HIA, in support of an iwi-led submission on the proposed Fluoridation Referendum Bill.
- Included a complete Environmental Health Risk Assessment (EHRA) appendix covering hazard identification, dose-response, exposure assessment, risk characterisation, and risk management.
- Modelled likely impacts on dental caries prevalence, health equity for Māori and Pasifika communities, and Te Tiriti o Waitangi obligations under active protection and equity principles.

Quantitative Analysis — Predictors of Adolescent Stress | PUBH 726 Applied Biostatistics 2: Regression

Methods

2024

- Built and validated a multivariable linear regression model in a cohort of 1,332 adolescents to estimate the effect of exercise time on stress, adjusting for age, sex, BMI, and sleep duration.
- Conducted full diagnostic assessment: data cleaning, multicollinearity (VIF), linearity, homoscedasticity, normality of residuals (histogram and Q-Q), and influential point assessment using DFBETA.
- Performed backwards elimination with confounder testing (10% change rule); assessed interaction between sleep and centred age; produced a lay summary translating findings for non-technical audiences.

Policy Essay — Institutional Racism in Housing & Hauora Māori | Hauora Māori paper, University of Otago

2024

- Examined how institutional racism within Aotearoa's housing system produces inequities in hauora Māori, with comparative analysis of indigenous housing outcomes in Canada and Australia.
- Applied Te Whare Tapa Whā as an analytical framework, linking land alienation and housing conditions to wairua, hinengaro, tinana, and whānau wellbeing.
- Evaluated papakāinga housing and the Whai Kāinga Whai Oranga programme as anti-racist housing policy responses, including barriers to delivery and recommendations for structural reform.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Dental Assistant | Various practices, Wellington

2015–present

Sustained frontline clinical experience across multiple Wellington dental practices, with direct exposure to New Zealand's oral health workforce capacity issues, patient access barriers, and the cost-of-care drivers that shape current oral health policy debates.

- Supported clinical care across restorative, periodontal, surgical, and prosthetic procedures, including infection control, instrument processing, four-handed assisting, and patient communication.
- Managed patient documentation and clinical records to a high standard of accuracy, in line with New Zealand privacy legislation and Dental Council standards.
- Coordinated daily clinical workflows, patient scheduling, and supplier liaison in fast-paced practice environments.
- Worked across socioeconomically and culturally diverse patient populations, including patients with limited English.
- Supported induction and training of new clinical and administrative team members.

Programme Monitor | Universidad de Antioquia, Colombia

2013–2015

Provided coordination, advisory, and analytical support for a university-wide programme supporting 300 students from vulnerable backgrounds, the majority of whom were single mothers re-entering education.

- Analysed student progress data, monitored cohort performance against milestones, and reported findings to programme leadership.
- Developed and communicated advice to senior academic staff, identifying programme delivery issues and recommending practical solutions.
- Served as the central point of contact between academic staff and students; mentored students from non-traditional backgrounds through course selection and academic challenges.
- Managed programme documentation, tracking systems, and confidential records.

SKILLS

- Policy analysis and writing: regulatory impact assessment, health impact assessment, submission drafting, briefings
- Quantitative methods: applied biostatistics, multivariable linear regression, model diagnostics, interaction testing, lay translation of statistical findings
- Te Tiriti o Waitangi analysis: applied use of partnership, protection, and participation principles in policy work; Te Whare Tapa Whā framework
- Subject expertise: oral health policy, tobacco control, health equity, environmental health
- Stakeholder engagement: communicating technical information clearly across clinical, academic, and policy audiences
- Software: Microsoft Office (advanced); statistical software (Stata, used through PGDipPH); reference management
- Languages: English (fluent), Spanish (native)

REFEREES

Available on request.